

# Fearnleys Dry Bulk Weekly

Jan 14, 2026





## Capesize/Newcastlemax

We still expect a downtrend in the coming weeks. Levels are much more likely to remain similar to the same period in 2024 rather than in 2025.

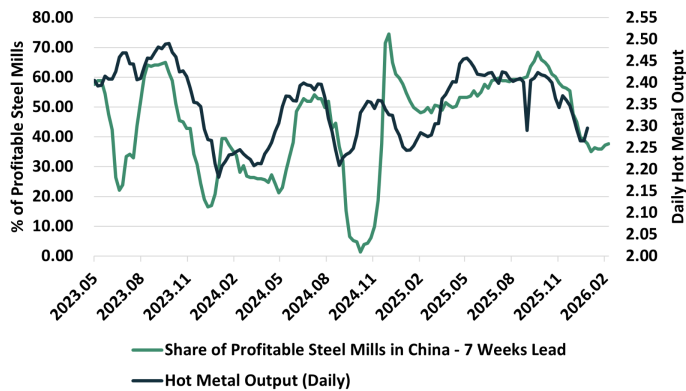
**Top left chart:** Hot metal output in China usually lags steel mill profitability by a few weeks. Hot metal output increased last week, but it does not look like it will start rising sustainably yet.

**Top right chart:** Higher backwardation = more urgency to buy, and vice versa. The futures curve suggests tailwinds for Capes through most of Q1, but the curve has recently become less backwardated.

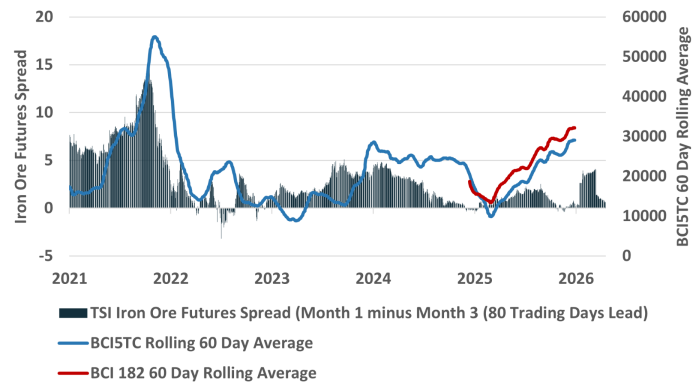
**Bottom left chart:** The price of copper is a good barometer of global industrial activity, and leads asset values with high accuracy. The suggestion is for further upside in values in the next months.

**Bottom right chart:** Hot metal output is higher to start 2026 than it was both in 2025 and 2024.

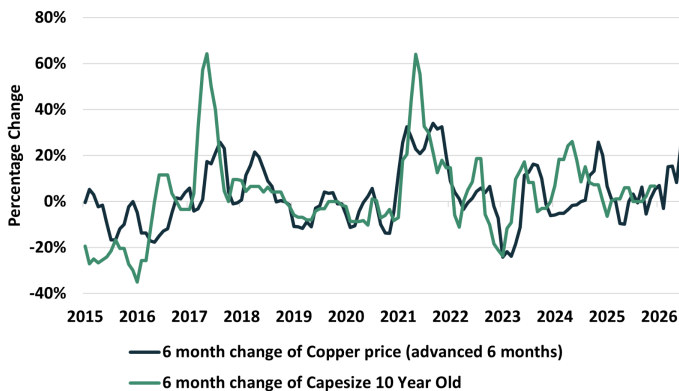
### Share of Profitable Steel Mills (7 Weeks Lead) vs Hot Metal Output



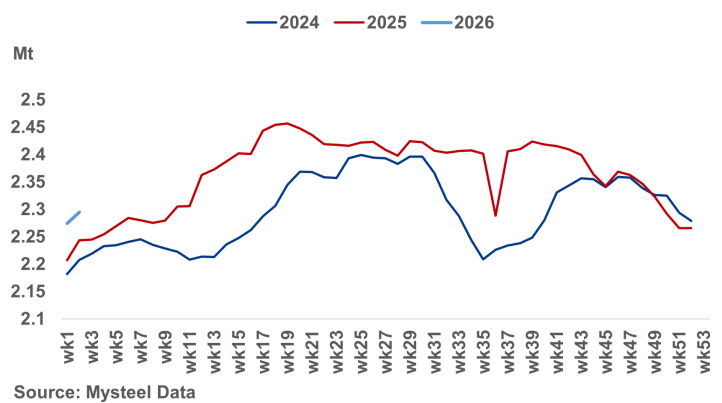
### Iron Ore Futures Spread, 1st Month Minus 3rd Month (3 Months Lead) vs BCI5TC 60 Days Rolling Average



### Copper Price Lead vs Capesize 10-Year Old



### China Hot Metal Output, 24 25 and 26 YTD



## Panamax/Kamsarmax

The indicators below still suggest a rising market in the coming weeks, although seasonal headwinds will of course be there.

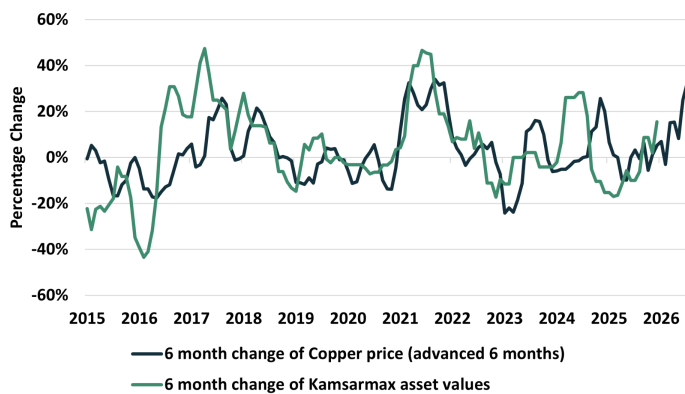
**Top left chart:** The price of copper is a good barometer of global industrial activity, and leads asset values with high accuracy. The suggestion is for further upside in values in the next months.

**Top right chart:** Since last week, the coal futures curve turned slightly less bullish. However, it is still suggesting a rising market over the next two months.

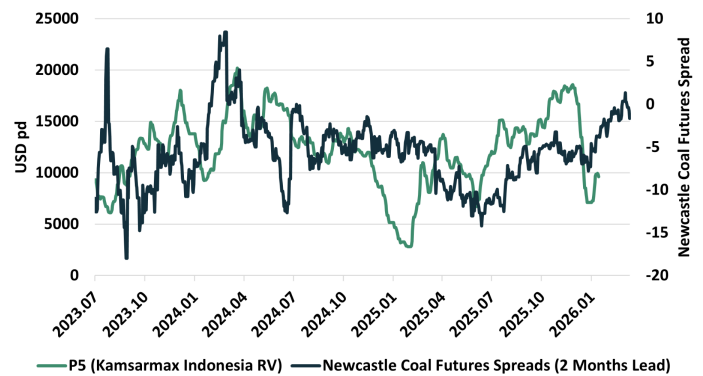
**Bottom left chart:** The net vessel change into the North Atlantic is positive, which more often than not correlates with a relative outperformance in the basin. That, along with positive indicators on the main routes should mean the basin will see a stable to firm development going forward.

**Bottom right chart:** The SATL tightness indicator correctly called the bottom, and suggests the market will trend up going forward.

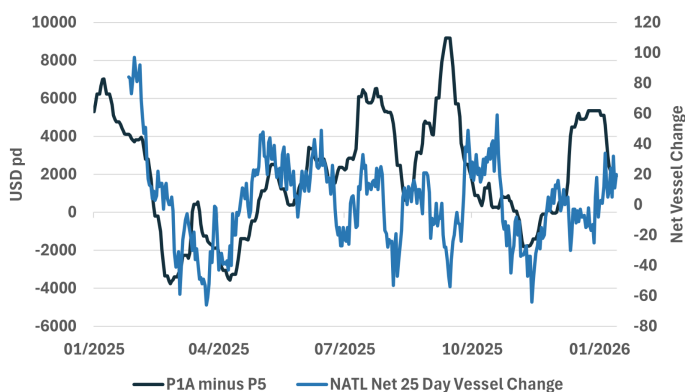
### Copper Price Lead vs Kamsarmax 10 Year Old



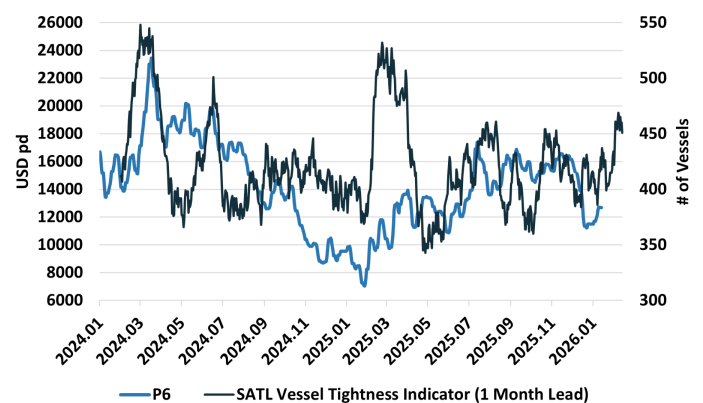
### P5 vs Newcastle Coal Futures Curve Spread (Lead 2 Months)



### North Atlantic net Vessel Change vs P1A minus P5



### South Atlantic Vessel Tightness Indicator (Lead 1 Month), vs P6



# Supramax/Ultramax

We still expect a stable to firm outlook in the near-term. The correlation between Industrial Metals and 1-year TC rates suggests the market could reach similar heights to 2021/22 within the next few months. We are sceptical of it happening, as physical commodity demand is not as strong as back then, nor are there any noteworthy congestion issues. Still, the direction-wise indication given by commodity prices is very clear.

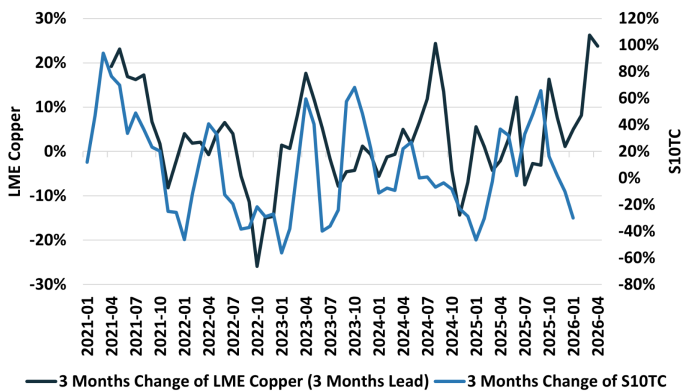
**Top left chart:** The three-month change in the price of copper looks very bullish for the coming months, and the three-month change of the S10TC index is very low.

**Top right chart:** Same as with the top left chart, but here illustrated a bit differently, and against 1 year TC. Rising momentum suggested through Q1 and the start of Q2.

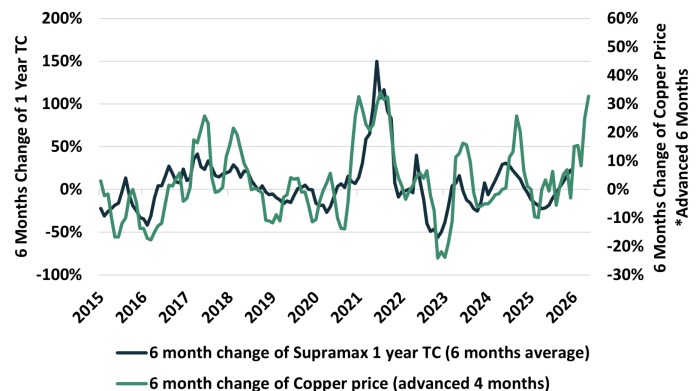
**Bottom left chart:** An industrial metals index including other metals as well, like Aluminium, Zinc and Nickel. This index is now at similar heights to the peak in Q1 2022. Can market levels climb to the same heights as back then? Right now, that seems like an unreasonable idea...

**Bottom right chart:** The price of copper is a good barometer of global industrial activity, and leads asset values with high accuracy. The suggestion is for further upside in values in the next months.

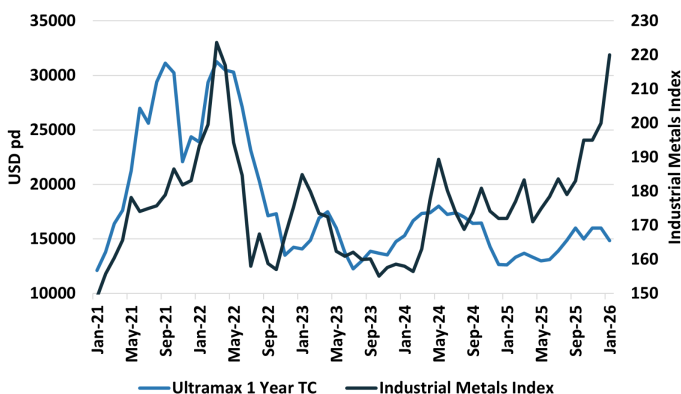
**Copper Price 3 Months Change, 3 Months Lead vs 3 Months Change of Supra 10TC**



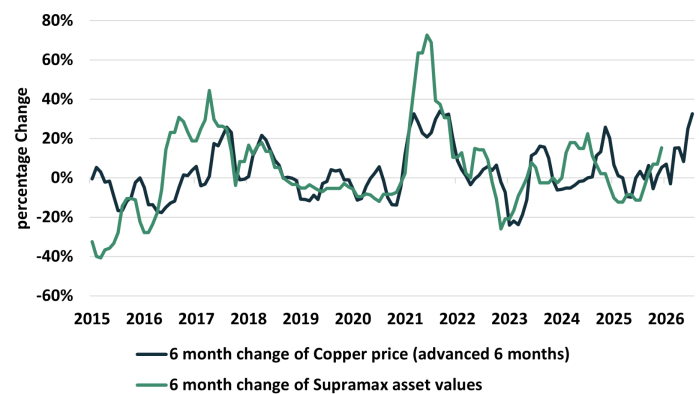
**Copper Price 6 months Change, 4 Month Lead vs Supramax 1 Year TC 6 Months Change**



**Industrial Metals Index vs Ultramax 1 Year TC**



**Copper Price Lead vs Supramax 10-Year Old**





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